Installing Python and marimo

Data Science 1 · with uv, on Windows and macOS

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Why uv?



uv is one program that takes care of everything you need to work with Python: it installs Python itself and the packages you need. So you don't download Python separately from python.org.

1. Check
2. Install uv
3. Python 3.12
4. Test folder
5. Test marimo
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Step 1 · Open a terminal and check



macOS

Cmd + Space, type Terminal and press Enter.



Windows

Click Start, type PowerShell and open Windows PowerShell (or the Terminal app).

Then type, in both cases:

```
uv --version
```

You see uv 0.x.x
uv is already installed. Update it with uv self update and go to Install Python 3.12.

command not found or not recognized
uv is not installed yet. Go to Install uv.

Step 2 · Install uv



macOS

```
curl -LsSf https://astral.sh/uv/install.sh | sh
```

This downloads uv's official install script and runs it.



Windows

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy ByPass -c "irm https://astral.sh/uv/install.ps1 | iex"
```

irm downloads the script, iex runs it. -ExecutionPolicy ByPass is needed because Windows blocks downloaded scripts; it only applies to this one command.

Then close the terminal completely (macOS: Cmd + Q), open a new one and check:

```
uv --version
```

Windows only · Turn off the Microsoft Store alias



Windows has a 'fake python' by default: a shortcut that opens the Microsoft Store when you type python. It can take priority over the real Python.

1. Start → Settings → Apps → Advanced app settings → App execution aliases
2. Turn off the switches for App Installer python.exe and python3.exe



Quick way: type aliases in the Start menu and choose Manage app execution aliases.

Step 3 · Install Python 3.12

The same command in both terminals:

```
uv python install 3.12 --default
```

Close the terminal, open a new one and check:

```
python --version
(Get-Command python).Source     # Windows
```

You should see Python 3.12.x; the last number may differ.



Windows: the second command should show a path ending in .local\bin\python.exe. If you see WindowsApps, the Store alias is still on.



The yellow message warning: The `--default` option is experimental is normal and can be ignored.

Step 4 · Test marimo in a test folder

1

Make a test folder

mkdir makes the folder, cd goes into it.

```
mkdir marimo-test
cd marimo-test
```

2

Start marimo

The first time takes a while. marimo creates test.py and opens it in your browser. If Windows Firewall asks for access, click Allow.

```
uv run --with marimo marimo edit test.py
```

3

Run a cell

In the cell below import marimo as mo, type:

```
print("Hello, world!")
```

4

Did it work?

Hello, world! appears below the cell. Press Ctrl + C in the terminal and type y. You can delete the marimo-test folder.

Run: Cmd + Enter (macOS) or Ctrl + Enter (Windows), or the play button next to the cell.

If it doesn't work

`uv: command not found / not recognized`

Close the terminal completely and open a new one. macOS: source $HOME/.local/bin/env or uv tool update-shell. Windows: restart the computer.

`running scripts is disabled`

Windows: you forgot -ExecutionPolicy ByPass. Copy the uv install command again, completely.

`python opens the Microsoft Store`

Or shows a version other than 3.12: check the Store alias and see with (Get-Command python).Source which program starts.

`Failed to spawn: marimo`

You forgot --with marimo. Use the complete command: uv run --with marimo marimo edit test.py

`The browser doesn't open`

Copy the link from the terminal (it starts with http://localhost:) and paste it into your browser.

`Another Python from python.org`

It can take priority for python. The lab still works: uv run picks the right Python itself.